

The Roof Replacement Planning Handbook

Measure the roof, compare systems and prepare better contractor questions

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Plan first. Price second.

This 12-page field guide is designed to be used beside HomeCostEngine calculators, measurements, product selections and contractor proposals. It does not try to replace a site inspection or local professional. Instead, it helps you make assumptions visible so quotes become easier to understand and compare.

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Use this guide for planning and education only. Verify final pricing, code, permits, suitability and scope with qualified local professionals.

ROOFING

Measure roof surface

Use roof planes, pitch and overhangs rather than interior living area to estimate quantity. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for assuming a 2,000 sq ft home automatically has a 2,000 sq ft roof. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Record measured surface area and convert it to roofing squares.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

What is the one assumption on this page that could change your price or contractor scope? Write it down before moving to the next chapter.

ROOFING

Understand the full roof system

Treat the covering, underlayment, starter, ridge, flashing and ventilation as one installed system. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for a proposal that names only the shingle brand and leaves accessories unspecified. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Ask for exact product lines and accessory scope.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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ROOFING

Plan tear-off and decking

Budget removal, disposal and a transparent method for concealed deck repair. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for open-ended statements that damaged plywood will simply cost extra. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Get a per-sheet or per-square-foot repair rate before tear-off.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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ROOFING

Review flashing and penetrations

Assign scope for chimneys, skylights, walls, valleys, pipe boots and solar equipment. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for reusing old flashing without explaining condition or manufacturer requirements. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- List every penetration and how it will be detailed.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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ROOFING

Compare material systems

Evaluate asphalt, metal, tile, slate or wood as complete installed assemblies. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for comparing material price without specialized labor, weight or maintenance implications. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Choose a system that fits climate, geometry and qualified installer availability.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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ROOFING

Compare warranties and proposals

Separate workmanship coverage from manufacturer material warranties. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for warranty marketing that does not explain registration, exclusions or installer obligations. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Compare scope, warranty and payment terms together.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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ROOFING

Prepare for installation

Plan access, landscaping protection, staging, cleanup, permits and final inspection. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for starting work without a clear responsibility for debris, magnetic cleanup or inspections. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Use a pre-start checklist and photograph property conditions.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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Project checklist

Resolve or document each item before you approve the final scope or purchase decision.

- Roof area and squares verified
- Material system specified
- Tear-off layers included
- Deck repair unit rate documented
- Flashing and ventilation scope
- Permit responsibility
- Warranty and cleanup details

CHECKPOINT

Any unchecked item is not automatically a problem. It is a prompt to clarify responsibility, price or assumptions in writing before money is committed.

WORKING DOCUMENT

Budget worksheet

Keep planned amounts, actual quotes and notes together. Do not hide allowances or contingency inside one total.

Measured roof area	Planned: \$ _____
Material system	Planned: \$ _____
Tear-off and disposal	Planned: \$ _____
Deck repair allowance	Planned: \$ _____
Flashing and ventilation	Planned: \$ _____
Permits	Planned: \$ _____
Access and protection	Planned: \$ _____
Contingency	Planned: \$ _____

Update this worksheet whenever a quote, selection or change order changes the project.

Next steps

You now have a practical framework for roofing planning. Move from generic assumptions to real measurements, written product selections and comparable local proposals as your project becomes more defined.

Use HomeCostEngine next

- Run the relevant free calculator at homecostengine.com.
- Compare contractor proposals with matching scope and allowances.
- Keep a separate contingency instead of hiding uncertainty inside fixed costs.
- Save this guide with your quotes, selections and final project records.

HOME COST PLANNING - CLEARER ASSUMPTIONS - BETTER QUESTIONS

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Educational planning resource only. Always verify project-specific decisions with qualified local professionals.